

READING STRATEGIES

Purpose

Tone

Style

Persuade

- Written Convince You To Change Your Thinking, Spend Money, Support A Cause, Or Offer A Solution To A Problem
- **Examples**
- Advertisements
- Commercials
- Political Speeches
- Opinion Editorials
- Movie Or Book Reviews

Inform

- Written to give information or describe something.
- Authors use facts and reasons to get the point across.
- **Examples**
- Textbooks
- News articles
- Informational Brochures
- Encyclopedias
- Schedules, charts, instructions

Entertain

- Written to interest the reader, or appeal to emotions such as pleasure, sadness, anger, or humor.
- **Examples**
- Fiction books and other stories
- Plays and movies
- Comic strips
- Video games
- Sports articles or programs

Question Stems

The purpose...

- What is the most likely reason the author wrote ...
- ...author probably wrote to...
- Why do you think the author choose...
- How do you think the author would feel about...
- Why do you think the author decided to...
- Why does the author begin (end) the story with...

Key Words
to describe
writer's
purpose

To Persuade	To Inform	To Entertain
Influence Encourage Convince Prove Urge Sell Inspire Convert Assure	Understand Show Describe Educate Discuss Explain Teach Give information Illustrate	Tell Share an experience Relate Provide details Create

Identify the author's purpose and explain your choice:

A wave is any movement that carries energy. Some waves carry energy through water. Others carry energy through gases, like air, or solid materials. If you drop a rock into a pool of water, a wave, or ripple of energy, skims across the pool's surface. In the same way, an underwater earthquake can release energy into ocean water. Then it carries a giant wave, or tsunami, across the surface until it hits land. If you hear a clap of thunder, sound waves (or vibrations) have carried the crashing BOOM to your ears. Sound waves speed through the air at about 1,100 feet (335 meters) per second. Light also travels through the air in waves. They travel at more than 186,000 miles (300 million meters) per second. So the light waves from a flash of lightning reach your eyes before that clap of thunder reaches your ears! Electrons travel in waves, too. They move back and forth in a solid wire, sending waves of electricity so you can turn on a light during the storm!

Author's Tone

- **Tone indicates the writer's attitude.**

Often described by adjectives, such as: **cynical, depressed, sympathetic, cheerful, outraged, positive, angry, sarcastic, prayerful, ironic, solemn, vindictive, intense, excited.**

- Tone is not an action. It is an attitude.

PRACTICE: Try saying, **“come here, Saad”** using the following tones:

- Commanding or bossy
- Secretive
- Loving
- Angry
- Excited
- Playful

Tone is not explained or expressed directly

- A reader must “read between the lines” to feel the authors attitude and identify the tone.
- Tone is different than “mood.”
- Tone is the **author’s** own attitude toward the subject
- Mood is the emotion the author wants the **readers** to feel while reading about the subject.
- An authors’ tone influences the story's’ mood and atmosphere.

Example

- An author writes a horror story using a **serious** and **sinister** tone.
- That tone helps create a **scary** atmosphere and a **nervous, frightened** mood for the readers.

“The girl remembered little from the raid at okeadan in which she had been captured. She knew her parents had been killed. She had no idea what had happened to her brothers and sisters. Much of what she had experienced had been so horrible that she had simply shut it out of her mind. . . .”

At Her Majesty's Request p. 17

Examples

Serious / solemn

This author's serious **tone** inspires an atmosphere of tragedy. This leads to a **mood** of sadness, sympathy, and caring in the reader when reading this passage.

Examples

“When he realized he was still in one piece, he knew that at the very least he must be completely flat, with his face peering out of his own bottom and his brains leaking out of his ears. . . .”

Toad Heaven p. 64

Humorous

This author’s humorous tone inspires a comic atmosphere. This leads to a playful mood in the reader. (It also helps the reader identify with and care about the characters.)

“By nightfall on Monday, the center of the storm had barely moved, and icy winds of hurricane force swept across an area from Virginia up to nova scotia, Canada. The wind was so powerful that in liberty, New York, the local train station had its roof entirely ripped off ...”

Blizzard p .

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Objective / impersonal

- This author's impersonal **tone** inspires a serious atmosphere, typical of nonfiction (such as news reports). The **mood** for this piece might be considered studious or academic

Examples

“ . . . the next minute, Winn-Dixie looked like a furry bullet, shooting across the building, chasing that mouse. He was barking and his feet were skidding all over the polished pick-it-quick floor, and people were clapping and hollering and pointing. They really went wild when Winn-Dixie actually caught the mouse.”

Because of Winn-Dixie p. 36

Enthusiastic

- This author’s enthusiastic tone inspires an active, lively atmosphere. The author hopes to influence the readers to be in an excited mood, anticipating more action.

Examples of Tone Words

- Cautious
- Humorous
- Affectionate
- Hostile
- Critical
- Objective
- Personal
- Violent
- Solemn / serious
- Sarcastic
- Disapproving
- Enthusiastic
- Desperate
- Pleading
- Indifferent

NEGATIVE	NEUTRAL	POSITIVE
Angry Annoyed Anxious Confused Depressed Mournful Outraged Critical Desperate Skeptical stressed	Unconcerned Direct Impartial Objective Unambiguous	Calm Cheerful Content Playful Relaxed Excited Friendly Light-hearted Humorous Appreciative



Writing Style

- In **Formal language** the tone is less personal than informal language.
 - used in writing for professional or academic purposes.
 - does not use colloquialisms, contractions or first person pronouns
- **Informal language** is casual and spontaneous.
 - used when communicating with friends or family in writing or in conversation.
 - used when writing personal emails and text messages
 - tone of informal language is more personal than formal language.

Style of the Writer

Author's style is the way he/she uses words to make ideas come alive on the page.

- Style techniques:
 - **Word choice**
 - **Sentence arrangement**
 - **Sentence structure**
- all work together to establish the meaning in the text influencing how we interpret the information presented.

Formal vs. Informal Writing

Formal Writing Style The tone is polite, but impersonal

Informal Writing Style The tone is more personal

- Formal

- To Whom it May Concern,
- Many people enjoy amusement parks.
- Studies show many people spend too much time on the computer.

- Informal

- Dear Grandma,
- You like amusement parks, right?
- Do you spend too much time on the computer like many people do?

Formal vs. Informal Writing

- Formal Writing Style Maintains a serious tone
- Informal Writing Style May use humor or more casual tone
- Examples:

Formal

- Thank you for sending the package. It was a thoughtful thing to do.
- A person should want others to take time to read what they write.

Informal

- Thanks for the package. It was thoughtful of you.
- Who would be crazy enough to write something that nobody reads?

Formal vs. Informal Writing

- Formal Writing Style Avoids using contractions and slang
- Informal Writing Style Freely uses contractions and slang

Examples:

Formal

- **It is** important to do homework.
- Going to an amusement park was a **thrilling** experience.
- It **does not** take a genius to **figure this out**.

Informal

- **It's** important to do homework.
- Going to an amusement park was **cool!**
- It **doesn't** take a genius to **get this**.

Formal vs. Informal Writing

1. Contractions

- I: The improvements **can't** be introduced due to funding restrictions.
- F: Improvements cannot be introduced due to funding restrictions.
- I: I **don't** believe that the results are accurate.
- F: The results are not believed to be accurate.

2. Phrasal verbs

- I: The balloon was **blown up** for the experiment.
- F: The balloon was **inflated** for the experiment.
- I: The patient **got over** his illness.
- F: The patient **recovered** from his illness.

3. Slang/Colloquialism

- I: It was raining **cats and dogs**.
- F: It was raining **very heavily**.
- I: Lecturers still **count on** students to use correct grammar and punctuation in essays.
- F: Lecturers **expect** students to use correct grammar and punctuation in essays.

Formal vs. Informal Writing

4. First person pronouns

- I: I considered various research methods for the study.
- F: Various research methods were considered for the study.
- I: We believe the practice is unsustainable.
- F: It is believed the practice is unsustainable.

5. Acronyms

- TAFE Technical and Further Education
- ANZAC Australian and New Zealand Army Corps
- QANTAS Queensland and Northern Territory Aerial Services

6. Initialisms

- UTS University of Technology Sydney
- ISO International Standards Organization
- OECD Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development

When analyzing style, you must look at a piece of writing FROM the overall structure of the text TO the small details and word choices. Be an editor, a critic, to answer the question: How would I describe this author's writing style?

Donovan and Larry were early for baseball practice. They decided to run up and down the bleachers to exercise before the rest of the team arrived. Larry was first to the top. He whispered to Donovan, "look over there." He pointed to a man sleeping on the highest, narrow bench of the bleachers. His pants and shirt were faded, worn, and too large for his thin frame. One big toe stuck out of a huge hole in his sock. His scraped-up shoes sat a few feet away. Donovan whispered, "we should help him out. Let's hide something good in his shoes. Then, when he wakes up, he will have a nice surprise."

Practice Exercise

1. Social media has a way of breaking down our personal communication skills. Social media has allowed all of us to interact solely through chat rooms, text messaging and posts made to Facebook, Twitter and other social media meeting spots. Meeting friends face to face has been declining rapidly over the last 5 years. Additionally, we post hundreds of selfies to show others how great we look, how adorable our children or pets are, or how amazing our backyard pool and barbecue pit is. Our pictures are liked, our posts commented on or re-tweeted and yet, we have lost that true essence of communication that can only be made with face to face interaction. Finally, friendships have become less intimate that they have ever been. When we meet face to face we can see body language and facial expressions. We can feel the way someone feels by the tone of their voice yet when we communicate only through social media outlets, those important characteristics of a conversation are non-existent. While it may be easier to type something to a friend than it may be to say it to their face, what we are becoming is akin to a race of anti-realistic, non-emotional and un-caring people altogether. Robots.

Identify Purpose and tone. Justify your answer

Practice Exercise

2. As everyone knows, a town's daily paper reports the news from around the world. Readers gain knowledge of world affairs by reading about wars starting and stopping, the national economy, and tragedies that befall people everyday like auto accidents and home fires. Secondly, readers also acquire basic information that is needed to be an informed citizen such as the workings of Congress and the geography of places all around the world. For instance, when the Pope visited Cuba, Americans learned about the history and geography of the island. Moreover, equally important to many readers, are the newspaper reports on the world of sports and entertainment. Many subscribers eagerly await the morning paper to find out the latest box scores of favorite teams or the television and movie listings for the day. Also, the newspaper predicts the weather, and the advertising helps readers save money by publishing information on the latest sales.

Identify Purpose and tone. Justify your answer

Reading Strategies:
Main Idea

Stated/Implied

Main Idea

The main idea answers the question,

- **“What is the author’s one *most* important point about the topic?”**
- 1. Must always **contain the topic** (the word, name, or phrase that tells who or what the paragraph is about)
- 2. Must always **make complete sense** by itself (even if you couldn’t read the rest of the paragraph)
- 3. Must be a general sentence that **sums up the details** in the paragraph

Main Idea in a Paragraph

- Most paragraphs have **topic sentences** that indicate what they are about. Supporting details prove the value of the main idea.

For example

- **Homeless people have many problems. In winter, it's hard to stay warm and it gets too hot in summer. It's also hard to keep things safe without a home. Worst is the lack of privacy.**
- **Topic sentence**
- **Homeless people have many problems.**
- **Supporting details**
 1. In winter, it's hard to stay warm
 2. gets too hot in summer
 3. hard to keep things safe without a home
 4. lack of privacy

Supporting Details = Additional information to help understand the main idea

Details consists of specific information

- Examples, Illustrations
- Facts and Statistics
- Reasons
- Incident
- Descriptive Details
- Steps or Procedures
- Comparison or Contrast.

also,

- *Who, what, when, where, why, how?*
The answers will be in the details.

What is the main idea of the passage?

Homework is a real problem. During free periods in school I go into the special ed. room and staff members read assignments to me. When I get home my mother reads to me. Sometimes she reads an assignment into a tape recorder, and then I go into my room and listen to it. If we have a novel or something like that to read, she reads it out loud to me. Then I sit down with her and we do the assignment. She'll write, while I talk my answers to her. Lately I've taken to dictating into a tape recorder, and then someone — my father, a private tutor, or my mother — types up what I've dictated. Whatever homework I do takes someone else's time, too. That makes me feel bad.

(On Being 17, Bright, and Unable to Read by David Raymond)

Location of the **Stated** **Main Idea** Sentence

Can appear **anywhere** in a paragraph:

- Most often it appears at the ***beginning***.
- The next most likely location is at the ***end***.
- The third possibility is somewhere else ***within*** the paragraph.
- Regardless of where it appears, it will have supporting details that explain more about it, by examples, or details to prove it.

- Read the entire paragraph before you decide
- Is it asking about:
 - *The overall main idea?*
 - *The subject?*
 - *The theme?*
- choose the answer that deals with the **entire selection**, *not* just part of the selection.
- Longer selections (textbook sections, essays, articles, and editorials) can have **overall** stated main ideas.
- The main idea is **general**. Details are **specific**.
- **Examples** are **always** details.
- Details are often introduced by *In addition, also, moreover, another, next, then, last, finally*, etc.

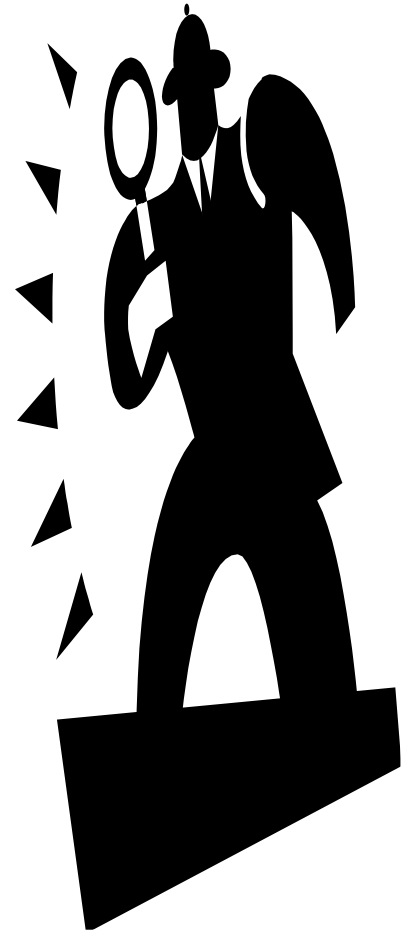
Remember:

- **Only ONE sentence** can be the stated main idea in a paragraph.
- **The main idea is NEVER a question.**
 - Examples are details that support the main idea, **so they cannot be the main idea.**
 - Watch for **words or phrases authors use to signal** their main idea: *the point is, it is important, thus, etc.*

Implied Main Idea

- The Implied Main Idea is **one that is NOT clearly stated in any one sentence in a passage**. It is only suggested or inferred by the supporting details. The author does not state it directly.

1. Find the topic of the selection.
2. Decide what the author wants you to know about the topic.
3. Express the idea in your own words.
4. An **implied main idea** is not stated directly but is strongly suggested by the supporting details.



Using Supporting Details to Find Implied Main Ideas

- The implied main idea
 - must be general enough to cover all the details,
 - must not be so broad that it is an overgeneralization
 - must not be a sweeping statement that suggests details not given
- To find the implied main idea, create a summary from the supporting details.
- Ask
 1. What is the topic, or subject, of the paragraph?
 2. What are the major supporting details?
 3. Based on the details about the topic, what point or main idea is the author trying to get across?

Figuring Out Implied Main Ideas

The child refused to speak.

The child crossed his arms and turned his back.

The child then threw himself to the floor.

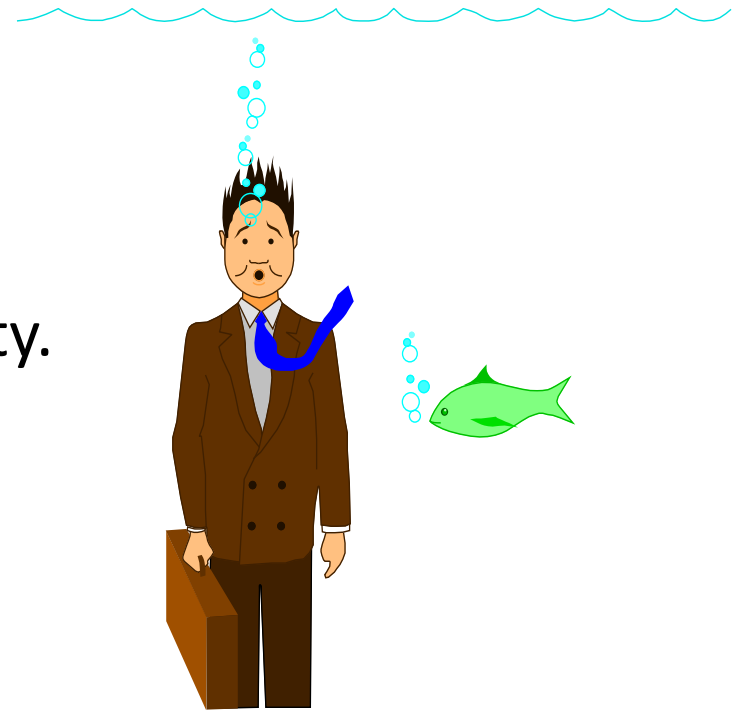
What is the implied general idea?

The child is having a Tantrum/outburst/ fit of temper



What is the implied main idea?

- Fear drains color from our faces, makes our teeth chatter, our hearts pound, our breath quicken, and our knees knock. Fear churns our stomachs, raises goose bumps, and causes jitters. Fear also raises feelings of anxiety and distrust, and may even cause us to change our behaviors. Obsessive fear can become a phobia that keeps us from enjoying life.
- Phobias keep us from enjoying life.
- Fear affects us in several ways.
- Fear is the result of distrust and anxiety.
- Fear affects many people.



What is the implied main idea?



- Green tea has been used for thousands of years in Asia as both a beverage and an herbal medicine. This herbal tea contains **catechin**, which is a type of tannin that acts as an astringent. Research suggests that men and women in Japan who drink five to six cups of green tea each day have much lower rates of cancer than people who do not. Green tea is also thought to lower cholesterol and blood sugar, control high blood pressure, stop tooth decay, and fight viruses. Green tea has even been credited with the power to slow down the aging process.
 - a. Green tea is an ancient herbal drink.
 - b. Green tea has caught the attention of medical researchers.
 - c. Green tea has many positive properties as a health drink.

- 1.Fire ants are painful and destructive pests. 2.The fire ant earned its name because of its venom. 3.The insect uses a wasp-like stinger to inject the venom, which causes a painful burning sensation and leaves tiny, itching pustules. 4.The ants will swarm over anyone or anything that disturbs their nests. 5.In addition to causing pain, fire ants damage many crops by eating the plants and by protecting other insects that damage crops. 6.Fire ants are attracted to soybeans, eggplant, corn, okra, strawberries, and potatoes.

1. What is the topic of the passage?

- a. Ant bites b. Fire ants
- c. Farming d. Pests

2. What does the author want you to know about the topic?

- a. Fire ants have a wasp-like stinger. c. Fire ants are pests to farmers.
- b. Fire ants swarm. d. Fire ants are painful and pesky.

3. Which sentence contains the main idea?

- a. 1 b. 2 c. 4 d. 5

Implied Main Ideas

identifying the topic and main idea:

- Remember to look for **repeated words**
- Mark **major supporting details**. Major details are often signaled by **addition words**

Addition Words

one	to begin with	also	further
first (of all)	for one thing	in addition	furthermore
second(ly)	other	next	last (of all)
third(ly)	another	moreover	final(ly)

IMPLIED MAIN IDEAS in Longer Passages

To find the implied central idea in a longer passage, you must ask the same three questions you used to find the main ideas in paragraphs:

- Who or what is this passage about?
(What is the **topic**?)
- What is the **central point** the author is trying to make about that topic?

When you think you know the central idea, you can test it by asking:

- Does *all or most* of the material in the passage support this idea?

Implied Main Ideas

Read the paragraph below. Then answer the question.

All people have a strong need to belong to groups, stemming from evolutionary pressures that increased people's chance of survival and reproduction when in groups rather than in isolation. This need may also be driven by the desire to feel protected against threat and uncertainty in everyday life or to gain a greater sense of personal and social identity. Moreover, people join specific groups in order to accomplish things that they cannot accomplish as individuals. Neither symphonies nor football games can be played by one person alone, and many types of work require team effort. Further, people join groups because of the social status and identity that they offer. An important part of people's feelings of self-worth comes from their identification with particular groups. Even a relatively low-status group can be a source of pride for individuals who are held in high esteem within the group; being big fish in small ponds can make people feel good about themselves, particularly people from individualist cultures. Finally, people may join groups simply because they like the members and want to have the opportunity to interact with them.

What is the **topic** of the paragraph?

Implied Main Ideas

All people have a strong need to **belong to groups**, stemming from evolutionary pressures that increased people's chance of survival and reproduction when **in groups** rather than in isolation. This need may also be driven by the desire to feel protected against threat and uncertainty in everyday life or to gain a greater sense of personal and social identity. Moreover, people **join** specific **groups** in order to accomplish things that they cannot accomplish as individuals. Neither symphonies nor football games can be played by one person alone, and many types of work require team effort. Further, people **join groups** because of the social status and identity that they offer. An important part of people's feelings of self-worth comes from their **identification with** particular **groups**. Even a relatively low-status group can be a source of pride for individuals who are held in high esteem **within the group**; being big fish in small ponds can make people feel good about themselves, particularly people from individualist cultures. Finally, people may **join groups** simply because they like the members and want to have the opportunity to interact with them.

What is the **topic** of the paragraph?

Joining groups

Implied Main Ideas

All people have a strong need to belong to groups, stemming from evolutionary pressures that increased people's chance of survival and reproduction when in groups rather than in isolation. This need may also be driven by the desire to feel protected against threat and uncertainty in everyday life or to gain a greater sense of personal and social identity. Moreover, people join specific groups in order to accomplish things that they cannot accomplish as individuals. Neither symphonies nor football games can be played by one person alone, and many types of work require team effort. Further, people join groups because of the social status and identity that they offer. An important part of people's feelings of self-worth comes from their identification with particular groups. Even a relatively low-status group can be a source of pride for individuals who are held in high esteem within the group; being big fish in small ponds can make people feel good about themselves, particularly people from individualist cultures. Finally, people may join groups simply because they like the members and want to have the opportunity to interact with them.

What is the **implied main idea** of the paragraph?

Implied Main Ideas

All people have a strong need to belong to groups, stemming from **evolutionary pressures that increased people's chance of survival and reproduction** when in groups rather than in isolation. This need may **also** be driven by **the desire to feel protected against threat and uncertainty in everyday life or to gain a greater sense of personal and social identity**. **Moreover**, people join specific groups in order **to accomplish things that they cannot accomplish as individuals**. Neither symphonies nor football games can be played by one person alone, and many types of work require team effort. **Further**, people join groups because of **the social status and identity that they offer**. An important part of people's feelings of self-worth comes from their identification with particular groups. Even a relatively low-status group can be a source of pride for individuals who are held in high esteem within the group; being big fish in small ponds can make people feel good about themselves, particularly people from individualist cultures. **Finally**, people may join groups simply because **they like the members and want to have the opportunity to interact with them**.

What is the **implied main idea** of the paragraph?

People join groups for a number of reasons.

Explanation

Each **major detail** in the paragraph is one reason that people join groups. Note that four of the major details are signaled by **addition words**.